

BENIN CAR IMPORT DUTIES 2026

THE COMPLETE ENGLISH GUIDE

Know your exact customs cost **BEFORE** you buy - professional-grade simulations

Cotonou is West Africa's busiest hub for imported used cars - serving Benin, Nigeria, Niger and the whole hinterland. This guide gives you what no auction listing ever shows: the duty you will actually pay, computed with our professional simulation engine, calibrated on the official tariff schedule in force and proven daily by our customs brokerage practice at the Port of Cotonou.

BONUS: free online simulator at adtranslogistics.com/simulateur - 2,253 vehicles referenced. Amounts in FCFA (XOF); \$1 = ~560 FCFA.

1. How much will you pay? The quick formulas

Customs assigns your car a reference value (CIF), then applies the schedule. Our simulation engine reduces it to four simple formulas:

Vehicle category	Total duty formula
Standard sedan (under 13 HP fiscal)	$\text{CIF} \times 31.60\% + 98,600 \text{ F}$
Sedan/SUV 13 HP and above (most SUVs, V6)	$\text{CIF} \times 40.21\% + 98,600 \text{ F}$
Trucks, buses, vans	$\text{CIF} \times 23.34\% + 98,600 \text{ F}$
Road tractors	$\text{CIF} \times 19.21\% + 98,600 \text{ F}$

2. Simulation examples (2026 schedule)

Vehicle	Customs value	Duty (FCFA)	approx. USD
Toyota Yaris 2007	1,523,592 F	580,025 F	\$1,036
Toyota Corolla 2007	2,019,498 F	736,721 F	\$1,316
Toyota Camry 2007	2,058,856 F	926,426 F	\$1,654
Toyota RAV4 2013	5,749,289 F	2,410,275 F	\$4,304
Toyota Highlander 2008	4,470,165 F	1,895,964 F	\$3,386
Lexus RX350 2013	8,996,289 F	3,715,827 F	\$6,635
Old sedan (floor value)	1,500,000 F	572,570 F	\$1,022

KEY INSIGHT: at equal value, a sub-13HP sedan (Corolla, Elantra...) pays ~22% LESS duty than a 13HP+ SUV or V6. Check the engine before you bid at auction!

3. Reference value: how customs prices your car

Customs does not use your auction invoice. It applies its own reference value per model and year, plus a flat freight amount by origin zone:

Purchase zone	Flat freight added
North America (USA, Canada)	600,000 F

Purchase zone	Flat freight added
Europe	300,000 F
Asia / Middle East	450,000 F

Floor values apply: 1,500,000 F minimum for cars (about 4 in 10 older cars are assessed at the floor) and 2,500,000 F for trucks.

4. Re-export to Niger / hinterland (EX8)

If the car leaves Benin for Niger, Burkina or Mali, customs charges a single flat fee of 305,000 F per vehicle (since February 2025) instead of full duties. Convoy and corridor escort are extra. This is how most Nigerian and Nigerien dealers operate through Cotonou.

5. The 10 clearance steps

- 1 Arrival notice**
The shipping line issues the arrival notice - storage clock starts fast.
- 2 BESC/CTN validated**
The Electronic Cargo Tracking Note must be validated BEFORE arrival - fines otherwise.
- 3 Delivery order**
Swap your original Bill of Lading for the delivery order (line fees apply).
- 4 Customs declaration**
A licensed broker files the SAD in SYDONIA - reference values apply here.
- 5 Pay the duties**
Pay the assessed amount and keep the official receipt.
- 6 Port & terminal fees**
Handling, parking (USN, vacation) - payable before release.
- 7 Inspection**
Depending on the control lane, physical inspection may occur.
- 8 Release order (BAE)**
With the BAE you can take the vehicle out of the terminal.
- 9 Registration**
Plates and registration card at ANaTT.
- 10 Road-ready**
Technical inspection + insurance before driving.

6. Documents checklist

- Original Bill of Lading or telex release
- Purchase invoice / bill of sale
- Foreign title / registration card
- Validated BESC/CTN
- Owner's ID (+ tax ID for companies)
- Power of attorney if a broker acts for you
- Readable VIN - photos recommended

We clear and deliver door-to-door, and we answer in English. AD TRANS LOGISTICS - Licensed customs broker, Port of Cotonou - WhatsApp +229 01 97 50 05 55 - www.adtranslogistics.com